

GUILT

Guilt **FITS THE FACTS** of a situation whenever:

- A.** Your behavior violates your own values or moral code.
- B.** Other example: _____

Follow these suggestions when *both* guilt and shame
are **NOT JUSTIFIED** by the facts or are **NOT EFFECTIVE**:

OPPOSITE ACTIONS for Guilt

Do the **OPPOSITE** of your action urges. For example:

- 1.** **MAKE PUBLIC** your personal characteristics or your behavior (with people who won't reject you).
- 2.** **REPEAT** the behavior that sets off guilt over and over (without hiding the behavior from those who won't reject you).

ALL-THE-WAY OPPOSITE ACTIONS for Guilt

- 3.** **NO APOLOGIZING** or trying to make up for a perceived transgression.
- 4.** **TAKE IN** all the information from the situation.
- 5.** **CHANGE YOUR BODY POSTURE.** Look innocent and proud. Lift your head; "puff up" your chest; maintain eye contact. Keep your voice tone steady and clear.

Follow these suggestions when guilt is **NOT JUSTIFIED** by the facts or is **NOT EFFECTIVE**
but SHAME IS JUSTIFIED (you will be rejected by people you care about if found out):

OPPOSITE ACTIONS for Guilt

- 1.** **HIDE** your behavior (if you want to stay in the group).
- 2.** **USE INTERPERSONAL SKILLS** (if you want to stay in the group).
- 3.** **WORK TO CHANGE** the person's or group's values.
- 4.** **JOIN A NEW GROUP** that fits your values (and will not reject you).
- 5.** **REPEAT** the behavior that sets off guilt over and over with your new group.

ALL-THE-WAY OPPOSITE ACTIONS for Guilt

- 6.** **VALIDATE YOURSELF.**